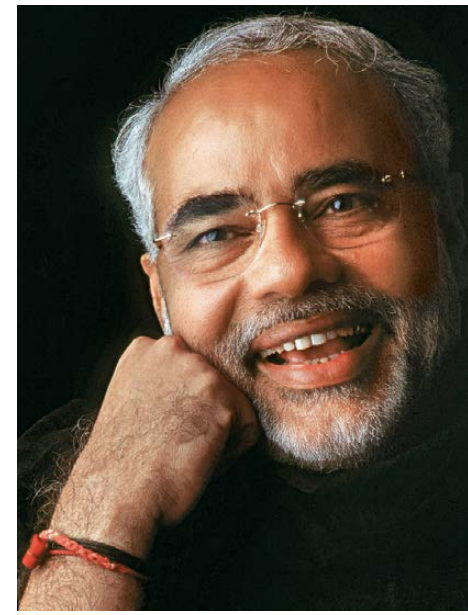
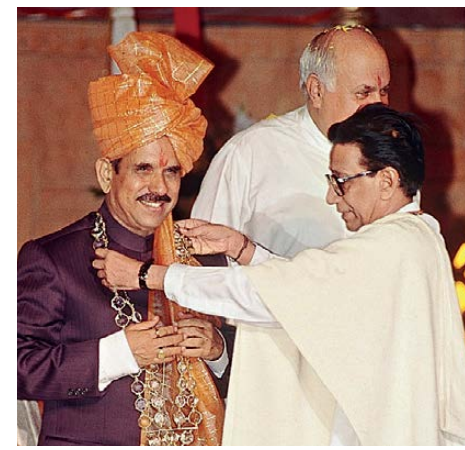
SAIBAL DAS



BANDEEP SINGH



THE FLEX Clockwise from top, Bihar CM Rabri Devi; Gujarat's Narendra Modi; Maharashtra CM Manohar Joshi with Shiv Sena boss Bal Thackeray; DMK supremo M. Karunanidhi; AIADMK and Tamil Nadu's J. Jayalalithaa



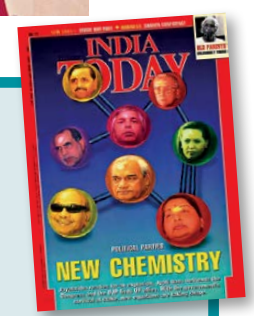
HEMANTH PITHWA

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ing—in a "historic blunder" (Basu's words), his politbureaucrats had refused to allow him to shift office to New Delhi's South Block, or we may have had a Marxist PM. Mayawati was sworn in as chief minister for the first time in 1995. The Shiv Sena went from being impetuous sidekick to form the first non-Congress government in Maharashtra. The Laloo Yadav imprint on Bihar only got more definite proof after he had to go, owing to the fodder scam; in came his wife Rabri Devi. A certain Mr Modi came into Gujarat at the fag-end, impervious even to Prime Minister Vajpayee's exhortations. And down South, it was either Dravidian scriptwriter M. Karunanidhi or the imperious J. Jayalalithaa. ■



Political Parties: New Chemistry
Jul. 13, 1998

> "There is a subdued realisation that one troubled chapter of the BJP-led coalition's history is drawing to a close. Jayalalitha looks set to part ways with the government... the war of words has reached ridiculous heights."